



FIGB

Lesson 9: Receiving the Opening Lead

1 DEDUCTIONS FROM THE OPENING LEAD

OPENING LEAD	WHAT IT TYPICALLY MEANS
LOW 5 4 2 	→ HAS AN HONOR
HIGH K 10 7 	→ NO HONOR
HONOR Q J 9 	→ SEQUENCE

2 FUNDAMENTAL RULE



NO ONE LEADS UNDER AN ACE IN TRUMP!



If they lead low, they do **NOT** have the Ace.

3 DUCKING SPECIFIC HONORS



LEAD:
K

DUCK!
(let the King win)

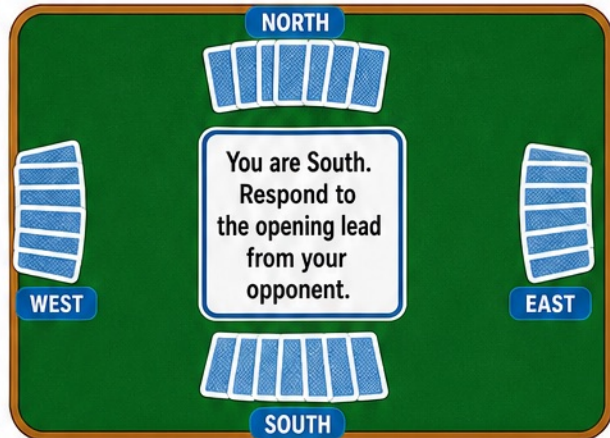


LEAD:
K

DUCK!
(let the King win)



Duck when it helps your long-term plan.



4 DUCKING FOR PLAY PLAN



Sometimes you duck to **maintain control** of the suit.



Duck to **break** defensive communications.

5 PROTECTING THE ACE FROM A RUFF



If you risk a ruff, **take immediately** with the Ace.



6 TAKE OR DUCK? DECISION TREE



Is the card dangerous if you duck?

YES

TAKE IT!

Don't let them gain advantage.

NO

CAN YOU BENEFIT BY DUCKING?

YES

DUCK!

It supports your plan.

NO

CONSIDER THE CONTEXT

Score, vulnerability, declarer's plan, etc.



GOOD DECISIONS

BRING THE CONTRACT DOWN!



THINK, PLAN, AND PLAY SMART!

Every lead gives you information.
Use it to your advantage!

Maestro Franci